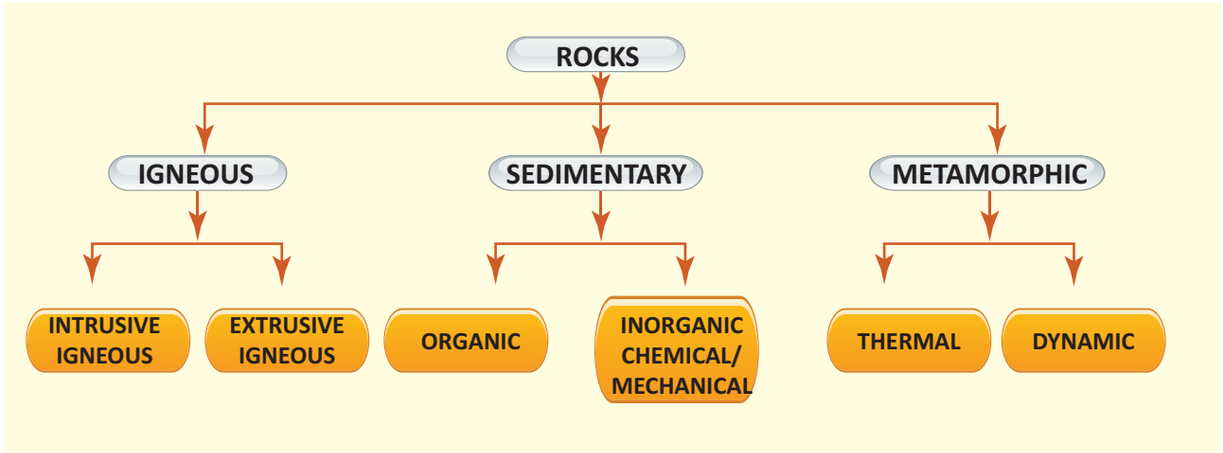


Igneous Rocks

The igneous rocks are formed by the solidification of molten magma. These rocks are also called as the '**Primary Rocks**' or '**Parent Rocks**' as all other rocks are formed from these rocks.



Igneous rock



The word **Igneous** is derived from the Latin word '**Ignis**' means '**fire**'

Characteristics of Igneous Rocks

1. These rocks are hard in nature
2. These are impermeable
3. They do not contain fossils
4. They are associated with the volcanic activities
5. These rocks are useful for construction works

Types of Igneous Rocks

Igneous Rocks are of two types. They are:

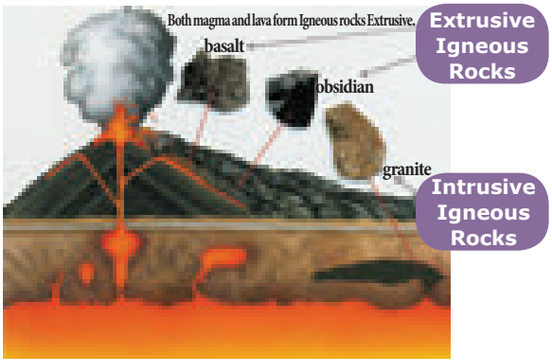
1. Extrusive Igneous Rocks
2. Intrusive Igneous Rocks

1. Extrusive Igneous Rocks

Can you visualize the lava comes out from a volcano? Lava is actually a fiery red molten magma comes out from the interior of the earth on its surface. After reaching the earth surface the molten materials get solidified and form rocks. Rocks formed in such a way on the crust are called Extrusive igneous rocks. These rocks are fine grained and glassy in nature due to rapid solidification. Basalt found in the north western part of peninsular India is the example for this type of rock.

2. Intrusive Igneous Rocks

The molten magma sometimes cools down deep inside the earth's crust and becomes solid. The rocks formed this way is called '**Intrusive Igneous Rocks**'. Since the cool down slowly and form crystals. Hence they are called 'crystalline rocks'. Intrusive Igneous rocks are two types. They are, 1. Plutonic rocks 2. Hypabysal rocks. The deep seated rocks are called 'Plutonic rocks' and the ones formed at shallow depths are called 'Hypabysal rocks'. Granite, Diorite and Gabbro are the example of plutonic rocks and dolerite is an example of hypabysal rocks.



Extrusive & Intrusive Igneous rocks

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